

Friederike J.R. Wölke

I'm a biologist currently living in Sweden where I'm doing a PhD on investigating the Evolution of Biomes in Madagascar using Plant Phylogenetics at Stockholm University.

Research identifiers: [ORCID 0000-0001-9034-4883](#) | [Scopus ID 58319054200](#) | [ResearcherID JGL-8008-2023](#)

Education

PhD in Plant Systematics | 2025-present

Stockholm University | Stockholm, Sweden

“Reconstructing the origin and evolution of Madagascar’s biomes using plant phylogenomics”

PhD in Spatial Sciences | 2023-2025

Czech University of Life Sciences | Prague, Czech Republic

“Predicting temporal change in species distributions from single snapshots”

MSc in Biodiversity, Ecology & Evolution | 2019-2022

Leipzig University | Leipzig, Germany

Thesis entitled *“Fruit size evolution is shaped by divergent selective regimes related to disperser availability and habitat type in palms (Arecaceae)”*

BSc in Biology | 2016-2019

Leipzig University | Leipzig, Germany

Thesis entitled *“Determinants of Microbial Respiration and Biomass across Global Drylands”*

Professional experience

7/2025 - 10/2025

[Laboratory of Quantitative Ecology](#), Department of Botany, Faculty of Science, Charles University, Prague, Czech Republic

R package developer for [RRatepol](#)

05/2024 - 08/2024

Czech University of Life Science, Prague, Czech Republic

Field botanist for [GRACE](#)

06/2023 - 08/2023

Evolution & Adaptation group, German Centre for Integrative Biodiversity Research (iDiv) Halle-Jena-Leipzig, Germany

Research Assistant with Rachel Souza-Ferreira working on the related evolution of armature in plants and megaherbivory in animals

12/2022 - 05/2023

Vegetation and Macroecology Group, Helmholtz-Centre for Environmental Research (UFZ), Halle, Germany

Research Assistant with Maryna Golivets for InvaCost Plants: Literature harvesting for economic costs of invasive plants

04/2022 - 08/2022

Evolution & Adaptation group, German Centre for Integrative Biodiversity Research (iDiv) Halle-Jena-Leipzig, Germany

Research Assistant/Masters Student working at the tropical house of the Zoo Leipzig; Lab work with spectrometer, preparing RNA samples; Phylogenetic comparative methods

10/2019 - 03/2022

Experimental Interaction Ecology group, German Centre for Integrative Biodiversity Research (iDiv) Halle-Jena-Leipzig, Germany

Research Assistant: Field work at MyDiv Experimental site, ECOTRON experimental facility; Lab work with soil samples, invertebrates

06/2019 - 09/2019

Biology, Ecology & Diversity of Invertebrates from Marine Environment (BEDIM), Universidad Catolica del Norte, Coquimbo, Chile

Research Internship: Identification and quantification of marine invertebrates from microplastics samples

04/2018 - 09/2020

Molecular Evolution and Plant Systematics & Herbarium Leipzig, Leipzig, Germany

Student Assistant: Restoring old herbarium specimen (winter semester), teaching plant identification classes (summer semester)

Institutional responsibilities

Department of Ecology, Environment & Plant Science, Stockholm University, Stockholm, Sweden

- 2026 - present Co-organization of bi-weekly 'PhytoFika' seminars
 - 2026 - present PhD student representative at the Department Board
 - 2026 - present Organization committee for Department Conference 2026
 - 2026 - present Teaching Organismernas mångfald och evolution (Evolutionary Theory & Botany)
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Grants

2026

Albert & Maria Bergström's Foundation: Research grant for fieldwork in Madagascar: *Peponidium*

2026

C.F. Liljevalchs Foundation: Travel grant for fieldwork in Madagascar: *Peponidium*

2024

Internal Grant Agency - Czech University of Life Sciences Prague: 1-year research project funding: 'Towards predicting temporal trends in biodiversity change from static patterns'

2020

DAAD-PROMOS scholarship to increase mobility of German university students: Funding for field work campaign in Madagascar (cancelled because of COVID)

2019

DAAD-RISE scholarship for research internships abroad: Funding a 3 month stay in Coquimbo, Chile (June-September 2019)

Other work experiences

2026 (4 weeks)

Madagascar, Africa

Botanical field work along Madagascar's north-east coast to collect voucher-backed silica samples for genomic work from genera: Uapaca and Peponidium

2024

Czechia

Field botanist for plot-based vegetation surveys in grasslands along the Czech-Austrian border